READIFY

Discovery readout

What we learned about who feels the pain — and where to aim first.

September 13

WHAT WE LEARNED

Casual readers show the strongest, most-repeated pain — that's Readify's first target

Sharpest signal

Casual readers name the same three pains, again and again

Two layers

A tracking job to be done, plus an emotional pull to make reading fun

Clear opening

Every competitor solves one pain — none solves all three

Saving, retention, and "what to read next" are the three pains they name most

1

Can't save & centralize

No easy home for to-read-later posts across social media

Most seen

2

Forget what they read

Passive reading leaves nothing behind; they re-read to recall

2nd most seen

3

Don't know what's next

Goodreads recommends poorly; social feeds overwhelm

3rd most seen

They also want reading to feel less like guilt and more like connection

Escape the scroll

Bored of games & social media — but the pull is guilt-driven, not deep desire

Belong somewhere

Want a community to share ideas and connect over what they read

Revisit past selves

Want to return to old reflections · hypothesis: a “letter to future self”

Engineers have the opposite need — low friction beats a retention layer they won't use

The felt pain

Copy-paste-to-AI friction

Dense articles mean a manual step: copy from the page, paste into Claude to summarize.

INSIGHT

The retention layer may not fit this persona at all

They read for the moment, not to remember — and organization isn't a felt need when Claude solves it on demand.

RESEARCHER

Researchers feel one sharp pain: finding relevant articles is slow — and AI hallucinates

The job

Surface topic-relevant sources fast, without made-up ones

Only 1 interview so far

Signal is real but thin — one more conversation before we weigh it.

PERSONA DECISION

We're betting on casual readers, cutting journalists, and gathering more signal on the rest

Casual reader	Primary bet — richest, most-repeated pain	PRIMARY BET
Engineer	Keep exploring — different shape, needs framing	MORE INTERVIEWS
Researcher	One more interview before we decide	1 MORE INTERVIEW
Journalist / advertiser	Out of scope for now	OUT

COMPETITOR RESEARCH

Each competitor owns just one pain — no one owns all three, and that's the opening

Readwise

Owns: Saving & tracking

Highlight-to-save, notes, streaks

Reddit

Owns: Connection

Forum built around shared interest

Goodreads

Owns: What to read

Discovery, but weak recommendations

Readify's shot: connect saving, memory, and recommendation into one loop — the gap none of them fill.

Hoàn

Two layers: non-negotiable tracking, plus an emotional/social moat decision-making need

Non-negotiable · the tracking job

- Saving
- Prioritizing
- Reminding
- Note-taking

Moat · makes reading fun

- Self-created streaks
- Read-together
- Recommend books to each other
- Anonymous → friends through shared activity
- Letter to future self

What we're deliberately avoiding — and the questions still open

Avoid

- An overwhelming, random news feed
- Extreme streak obligation

Open questions

- How feasible is storing image data for physical-book users?
- What triggers saving on an infinite scroll (Substack/FB)? Readwise uses highlight.

THE VISION

From a single save to a profile that reflects your reading back to you

Save

One tap, from anywhere you read

→

Profile

Your reading, gathered in one place

→

Landing page topics · sources · fav authors · notes

Deeper insights avg length · time-based patterns

NEXT

Run more casual-reader interviews · 1 more researcher, more engineers · resolve the save-trigger + image-storage questions